

Ecclesiastical Latin

EL-I.11: Pronouns and Prepositions

Resolve pronoun antecedents and reflexive reference while applying the case government of core prepositions

Stage	Stage I — Foundations
Prerequisite	EL-I.10 mastery: distinguish passive, deponent, participial, and <i>fio</i> structures
Next	EL-I.12, A Repeatable Method for Reading the Missal

Read *EL-GUIDE: Start Here* before using this packet. Course method, pacing, source conventions, and answer protocol are stated there; this module begins with its lesson and assumes previously taught terms.

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Part I

Lesson

CHAPTER 1

Unit 11: Pronouns and Prepositions

On completing this unit, you can:

- decline personal, demonstrative, and relative pronouns;
- distinguish reflexive possession from non-reflexive possession;
- apply the case government of core prepositions; and
- resolve pronoun antecedents in liturgical clauses.

1.1 Personal and reflexive pronouns

A **pronoun** stands for a noun phrase or points to a participant without repeating its noun. A **personal pronoun** identifies speaker, addressee, or another participant. A **reflexive pronoun** refers back to the subject of its own clause; a **possessive adjective** identifies a possessor but agrees with the thing possessed. These categories describe different relations, even when English translates them with similar words.

	First person		Second person		Reflexive
	sg.	pl.	sg.	pl.	sg./pl.
Nom.	ego	nos	tu	vos	—
Gen.	mei	nostri/nostrium	tui	vestri/vestrum	sui
Dat.	mihi	nobis	tibi	vobis	sibi
Acc.	me	nos	te	vos	se
Abl.	me	nobis	te	vobis	se

Forms in *-i* such as *nostri* commonly express an objective relation, while *nostrium* is normally partitive; the same distinction holds for *vestri/vestrum*. With personal pronouns, *cum* follows its object: *mecum*, *tecum*, *nobiscum*, *vobiscum*, *secum*. Possessives *meus*, *tuus*, *noster*, *vester*, and *suus* are adjectives and agree with the thing possessed. *Suus* refers back to the clause's subject; *eius* or *eorum/earum* normally means “his, her”, or “their” when the possessor is not that subject.

In reported thought, a subordinate clause, or some biblical and later usage, a reflexive may instead follow the sentence's logical point of view. Label this an **indirect reflexive** only when the wider syntax and source identify that center; do not use the exception merely to evade the ordinary subject rule.

1.2 *Is, ea, id* and *hic, hæc, hoc*

A **demonstrative** points out or identifies a referent (“this,” “that,” or sometimes “he/she/it”). An **emphatic pronoun** adds identity or emphasis (“self,” “the very one”) rather than reflexively directing the action back upon the subject.

	<i>is, ea, id</i> singular			plural		
	m.	f.	n.	m.	f.	n.
Nom.	is	ea	id	ii/ei	eæ	ea
Gen.	eius	eius	eius	eorum	earum	eorum
Dat.	ei	ei	ei	eis/iis	eis/iis	eis/iis
Acc.	eum	eam	id	eos	eas	ea
Abl.	eo	ea	eo	eis/iis	eis/iis	eis/iis

Emphatic *ipse, ipsa, ipsum*, “self, very one”, mostly follows first/second-declension adjective endings but has genitive singular *ipsius* and dative singular *ipsi* for all genders. The doxology especially requires masculine accusative *ipsum* and ablative *ipso*.

	<i>hic, hæc, hoc</i> singular			plural		
	m.	f.	n.	m.	f.	n.
Nom.	hic	hæc	hoc	hi	hæ	hæc
Gen.	huius	huius	huius	horum	harum	horum
Dat.	huic	huic	huic	his	his	his
Acc.	hunc	hanc	hoc	hos	has	hæc
Abl.	hoc	hac	hoc	his	his	his

1.3 The relative pronoun

A **relative pronoun** introduces a subordinate clause that describes or identifies an **antecedent**, the noun or noun-equivalent to which the pronoun refers. The antecedent supplies gender and number; the pronoun’s own job inside its clause supplies case.

	<i>qui, quæ, quod</i> singular			plural		
	m.	f.	n.	m.	f.	n.
Nom.	qui	quæ	quod	qui	quæ	quæ
Gen.	cuius	cuius	cuius	quorum	quarum	quorum
Dat.	cui	cui	cui	quibus	quibus	quibus
Acc.	quem	quam	quod	quos	quas	quæ
Abl.	quo	qua	quo	quibus	quibus	quibus

A relative pronoun takes gender and number from its antecedent but case from its own job inside the relative clause. In *Agnus qui tollis*, *qui* is masculine singular because of *Agnus* and nominative because it is the subject of *tollis*. In *dies quam fecit Dominus*, *quam* is singular and feminine in its context because of *dies*, but accusative because it is the object of *fecit*.

1.4 Core preposition government

Learn prepositions together with their case. Core accusative governors are *ad* (to), *ante* (before), *apud* (with, in the presence of), *contra* (against), *inter* (among), *ob* (on account of), *per* (through), *post* (after), *propter* (because of), *secundum* (according to), and *trans* (across). Core ablative governors are *a/ab* (from, by), *cum* (with), *de* (down from, concerning), *e/ex* (out of), *pro* (for, on behalf of), and *sine* (without). *In* and *sub* normally take the accusative for motion toward and the ablative for location: *in ecclesiam*, “into the church”; *in ecclesia*, “in the church”.

Worked example: *Dominus vobiscum*

Worked passage ID: W.I.47; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

vobiscum is *cum* plus ablative plural *vobis* in its required postpositive order. The conventional optative construal may be shown with interpretive *[sit]*: “The Lord be with you.”

Worked example: *Propter nos homines et propter nostram salutem descendit de cælis*

Worked passage ID: W.I.48; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Both *nos* and *nostram salutem* are accusative after *propter*; *nostram* agrees with *salutem*, not with *nos*. *de* governs ablative plural *cælis*. Translation: “For us men and for our salvation he came down from heaven.”

Worked example: *Per ipsum, et cum ipso, et in ipso*

Worked passage ID: W.I.49; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

The same masculine singular pronoun changes case: *ipsum* is accusative after *per*; both instances of *ipso* are ablative after *cum* and after *in* denoting location or state. Translation: “Through him, and with him, and in him.”

Worked example: *Hoc est enim Corpus meum*

Worked passage ID: W.I.50; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Neuter singular *hoc* is nominative subject; *Corpus* is the nominative predicate noun, and possessive *meum* agrees with it. Translation: “For this is my Body.”

Worked example: *Pater noster, qui es in cælis, dimitte nobis debita nostra*

Worked passage ID: W.I.51; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

noster is vocative masculine singular with *Pater*; relative *qui* is nominative subject of *es*. *in* governs ablative plural *cælis*; *nobis* is dative recipient; *debita nostra* is neuter plural accusative object. Translation: “Our Father, who are in heaven, forgive us our debts.”

1.5 Handwritten study and controlled composition

Copy the four pronoun charts and color-code antecedent agreement separately from clause function. Write every personal pronoun with *cum*. Sort the core prepositions into accusative, ablative, and two-case columns; then add one noun phrase to each. Transform *per eum*, *cum eo*, *in eo* to feminine and plural. Compose “for our souls”, *pro animabus nostris*; “through this word”, *per hoc verbum*; and “the Lord guards his own Church”, *Dominus Ecclesiam suam custodit*.

Part II

Practice

CHAPTER 1

Transfer, retrieval, and application

1.1 Personal and reflexive pronouns — transfer practice

Connection. A reference chain separates the grammatical person of a pronoun from the discourse person to whom it points.

Transfer task. For each personal or reflexive example in the lesson, draw an arrow to its referent and label person, number, case, and direct or indirect reflexive status.

Retrieval check. State why third-person reflexive *sui/sibi/se* does not by itself name gender.

1.2 *Is, ea, id* and *hic, hæc, hoc* — transfer practice

Connection. Demonstrative morphology and discourse distance are different questions that must both be answered.

Transfer task. Build parallel nominative and accusative cards for the two lesson paradigms, then annotate one lesson example with morphology, antecedent, and discourse role.

Retrieval check. Explain why matching gender and number does not yet prove the antecedent.

1.3 The relative pronoun — transfer practice

Connection. A two-link antecedent chain prevents antecedent agreement from being confused with internal case.

Transfer task. For every relative example in the lesson, draw one arrow from antecedent to gender/number and a second from the relative clause's verb or governor to case/function.

Retrieval check. Recite the two-axis rule and give one reason the antecedent's case need not match the relative's case.

1.4 Core preposition government — transfer practice

Connection. A two-case preposition map joins spatial relation to the exact case selected in the lesson.

Transfer task. Place each core preposition into accusative, ablative, or two-case columns. For each two-case item, add one motion-oriented and one location-oriented lesson use without inventing a universal English shortcut.

Retrieval check. State the government of *in* and *sub* in the two ordinary spatial patterns.

1.5 Handwritten study and controlled composition — transfer practice

Connection. A cumulative transformation reveals whether reference, agreement, and government remain coherent together.

Transfer task. Perform the lesson's gender-and-number transformations for *per eum*, *cum eo*, *in eo*, then add arrows from every pronoun to its referent and from every preposition to its governed case.

Retrieval check. Name one change caused by reference agreement and one caused by preposition government.

Part III

Worksheets

CHAPTER 1

Unit 11: Pronouns and Prepositions

Worksheet I.41 — Variant A

Worksheet ID: I.41

Focus: Personal/reflexive pronouns and preposition government**Use:** For each pronoun, give case, number, and antecedent where applicable.

1. Write nominative, genitive, dative, accusative, and ablative of first- and second-person singular pronouns.

-
2. Write the four personal pronouns with *cum*, singular then plural.

-
3. Distinguish *Petrus matrem suam amat* from *Petrus matrem eius amat*.

-
4. Choose the correct case and form: *pro (nos)*, *sine (tu)*, *ad (ego)*, *cum (vos)*.

-
5. Correct *Dominus cum vobis* to the conventional pronoun-preposition order.

-
6. **Text:** *Dominus vobiscum. Et cum spiritu tuo.*

Passage ID: I.41.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Parse both prepositional expressions, state the conventional optative construal, and translate.

Worksheet I.44 — Variant D**Worksheet ID:** I.44**Focus:** Core prepositions and cumulative pronoun parsing**Use:** State the governing word for every oblique case.

1. Sort by government: *ad, a/ab, apud, contra, cum, de, e/ex, inter, ob, per, post, pro, propter, secundum, sine, trans*.
-

2. Give the correct phrase: “through us”; “for her”; “without them” masculine; “from this altar”; “toward those churches”.
-

3. Parse the repeated pronoun in *per ipsum, cum ipso, in ipso*; explain each case.
-

4. Explain why *nostram* in *propter nostram salutem* is not a form of personal pronoun *nos*.
-

5. Correct *de cælos, propter nobis, cum eos*.
-

6. **Text:** *Propter nos homines et propter nostram salutem descendit de cælis.*

Passage ID: I.44.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Parse both accusative phrases and the source phrase; identify the finite verb and translate.

Part IV

Assessment

CHAPTER 1

Mastery assessment and record

Advance when: Write at least 90 percent of the displayed pronoun forms, govern at least 18 of 20 prepositional objects correctly, and resolve antecedent, gender, number, case, and function for at least nine of ten unseen relative pronouns.

Complete the assessment before opening the answer part. Record evidence, not confidence or elapsed time.

Evidence	First attempt	Delayed check
Date and conditions		
Worksheet ID and score		
Mastery task and result		
One recurring error family		
Correction stated as a rule		
Unseen or remediation item used		

If the criterion is met: continue to EL-I.12, A Repeatable Method for Reading the Missal.

If it is not met: Worksheets I.42 and I.43 remain optional remediation or delayed-recall variants.

Advance / remediate decision: _____ **Next review date:** _____

Reason in one complete sentence: _____

Part V

Answer Key

Open this part only after completing the assessment record. Use the comparison and alternative-answer protocol in EL-GUIDE.

CHAPTER 1

Practice models and rubrics

Personal and reflexive pronouns — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. Each arrow must identify the clause's controlling subject or other referent and the pronoun's case function. The third-person reflexive paradigm refers back to the relevant subject without distinct gender forms; context supplies the referent.

Is, ea, id and *hic, hæc, hoc* — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. The cards must preserve the irregular pronominal genitive and dative where taught and the correct neuters. A possible antecedent must match gender and number, but syntax, discourse, and sense must also establish the actual reference.

The relative pronoun — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. The first axis copies gender and number from the antecedent; the second assigns case from the relative pronoun's own clause. The clauses give the two words independent functions, so their cases may differ.

Core preposition government — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. The map must assign each one-case preposition correctly. In ordinary spatial uses, *in/sub* with accusative expresses motion toward or under, while the ablative expresses location; the actual construction and context remain controlling.

Handwritten study and controlled composition — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. All transformed pronouns must match their intended referent in gender and number while taking the case required by their preposition. The explanation must keep those two sources of form distinct.

CHAPTER 2

Unit 11: Pronouns and Prepositions

Solution I.41 — Variant A

Worksheet ID: I.41

Focus: Personal/reflexive pronouns and preposition government**Use:** For each pronoun, give case, number, and antecedent where applicable.

1. Write nominative, genitive, dative, accusative, and ablative of first- and second-person singular pronouns.
Answer / model: First: *ego, mei, mihi, me, me*. Second: *tu, tui, tibi, te, te*.
2. Write the four personal pronouns with *cum*, singular then plural.
Answer / model: *mecum, tecum, nobiscum, vobiscum*. The preposition follows and attaches to these pronouns.
3. Distinguish *Petrus matrem suam amat* from *Petrus matrem eius amat*.
Answer / model: First: “Peter loves his own mother”; reflexive possessive *sua* refers to subject Peter. Second: “Peter loves his/her [someone else’s] mother”; *eius* refers to a non-subject possessor.
4. Choose the correct case and form: *pro (nos)*, *sine (tu)*, *ad (ego)*, *cum (vos)*.
Answer / model: *pro nobis; sine te; ad me; vobiscum*.
5. Correct *Dominus cum vobis* to the conventional pronoun-preposition order.
Answer / model: *Dominus vobiscum*. With personal pronouns, *cum* is postpositive and attached.
6. **Text:** *Dominus vobiscum. Et cum spiritu tuo.*
Passage ID: I.41.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.
Parse both prepositional expressions, state the conventional optative construal, and translate.
Answer / notes: *vobiscum*: second-person plural ablative plus postpositive *cum*; *cum spiritu tuo*: ablative noun phrase. An analytic paraphrase may add interpretive *[sit]* in the first formula, but no verb is printed. “The Lord be with you. And with your spirit.”

Solution I.44 — Variant D

Worksheet ID: I.44

Focus: Core prepositions and cumulative pronoun parsing

Use: State the governing word for every oblique case.

- Sort by government: *ad, a/ab, apud, contra, cum, de, e/ex, inter, ob, per, post, pro, propter, secundum, sine, trans.*
Answer / model: Accusative: *ad, apud, contra, inter, ob, per, post, propter, secundum, trans.* Ablative: *a/ab, cum, de, e/ex, pro, sine.*
- Give the correct phrase: “through us”; “for her”; “without them” masculine; “from this altar”; “toward those churches”.
Answer / model: *per nos; pro ea; sine eis; ab hoc altari; ad eas ecclesias.*
- Parse the repeated pronoun in *per ipsum, cum ipso, in ipso*; explain each case.
Answer / model: *ipsum*: masculine singular accusative after *per*; both *ipso* forms: masculine singular ablative after *cum* and after *in* denoting state or location. Antecedent is Christ.
- Explain why *nostram* in *propter nostram salutem* is not a form of personal pronoun *nos*.
Answer / model: It is the feminine singular accusative possessive adjective *noster, nostra, nostrum*, agreeing with *salutem*; *nos* itself is the indeclinable-looking accusative personal form in *propter nos*.
- Correct *de cælos, propter nobis, cum eos*.
Answer / model: *de cælis*, ablative after *de*; *propter nos*, accusative after *propter*; *cum eis*, ablative after *cum*.
- Text:** *Propter nos homines et propter nostram salutem descendit de cælis.*
Passage ID: I.44.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.
 Parse both accusative phrases and the source phrase; identify the finite verb and translate.
Answer / notes: *propter nos homines*: accusative plural, with *homines* in apposition to *nos*; *propter nostram salutem*: feminine singular accusative; *de cælis*: masculine plural ablative; *descendit*: 3 singular perfect active in the Creed’s narrative. “For us men and for our salvation he came down from heaven.”

Part VI

Scope and Sources

CHAPTER 1

Scope and Qualifications

1.1 Packet boundary

This is module EL-I.11, *Pronouns and Prepositions*, in Triptych's print-first Ecclesiastical Latin curriculum. It imports one authoritative lesson, transfer practice for its internal submodules, two selected worksheets, one local mastery assessment, and matching solutions. This packet supplies the foundation pronoun and preposition system; expanded interrogative and indefinite paradigms begin Stage II.

The unprinted worksheet variants remain course-owned extension material; their omission is intentional and is not a claim that the module exhausts available practice. EL-GUIDE owns the course-wide study method, pacing, lookup discipline, answer protocol, source classes, and advancement rules; this packet assumes that orientation and terminology taught in prerequisite modules.

1.2 Controlling records and local state

Course-wide research records own the edition, passage, answer, curriculum, and source decisions; the leaf's module map records this packet's selection and transfer practice. EL-GUIDE owns the corpus, normalization, translation, non-authority, review, and answer conventions that apply here. Claim-local qualifications remain beside the affected material; check received wording against the course-wide passage inventory.

Any installed snapshot is a working study held from release until its exact bytes and outstanding distribution gates receive separate authorization.

CHAPTER 2

References

The following works are the course's controlling corpus and reference aids. Project-composed explanation, translation, analysis, exercises, and models are distinguished from received wording under the convention stated in the Scope and Qualifications appendix. Short source passages are identified so that the learner can verify their wider context. The adjacent edition manifest and passage inventory record exact source roles, checks, access states, and known rights limits.

2.1 Primary corpus

- Catholic Church, *Missale Romanum ex decreto SS. Concilii Tridentini restitutum, Summorum Pontificum cura recognitum*, editio typica (Rome, 1962). A searchable presentation of the edition is hosted by the Holy See's Biblia Clerus project: <https://www.clerus.org/bibliaclerusonline/EN/gmb.htm>.
- A page-image scan of the 1962 typical edition is available through the Church Music Association of America: <https://media.churchmusicassociation.org/pdf/missale62.pdf>. Page images, rather than unsourced transcriptions, should decide doubtful punctuation or spelling.

- The Clementine Vulgate is the principal biblical comparison corpus. The public-domain 1914 edition edited by Michael Hetzenauer and its provenance are described at <https://www.sacredbible.org/vulgate1914/>.

2.2 Grammar and lexicography

- J. H. Allen and J. B. Greenough, *New Latin Grammar for Schools and Colleges* (1903), a donor-declared public-domain reference whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <https://archive.org/details/allengreenoughsn01alle>.
- Charles E. Bennett, *New Latin Grammar*, 1918 revision, Project Gutenberg eBook 15665; public-domain text in the United States: <https://www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/15665>.
- Charlton T. Lewis and Charles Short, *A Latin Dictionary* (1879), searchable transcription: <https://logeion.uchicago.edu/lexidium>.
- Charles du Fresne, sieur du Cange, *Glossarium mediae et infimae latinitatis*, a donor-declared later-vocabulary aid whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <http://ducange.enc.sorbonne.fr/>.

The underlying 1903, 1918, 1879, and 1883–1887 printed works are public domain in the United States. Digital transcriptions and interfaces retain their own terms and are cited as access tools, not relicensed or reproduced wholesale. The 1962 Missal, Scripture, official text, and other received wording retain their own status; see the scope appendix, research records, and final-page rights notice.

Classical reference grammars describe the inherited system but do not by themselves explain every biblical or ecclesiastical development. The advanced volume therefore distinguishes classical baseline, Vulgate usage, later Christian usage, and stable liturgical formula instead of labeling every difference an “exception.”

2.3 Citation convention

Missal passages are cited by liturgical location and text genre rather than by a page number that varies among printings. Biblical texts are cited by book, chapter, and verse. Historical authors are cited by work and section wherever possible. A learner preparing a formal commentary should verify each passage against the edition actually being used and record any variant. These references are not a claim that every historical-linguistic question can be settled by the listed school grammars and dictionary interfaces.

CHAPTER 3

Generation Metadata

Last revised (UTC): 2026-07-21T17:50:56Z

Model: GPT-5-based Codex agent; unexposed: exact model identifier and model qualifiers

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (curriculum architecture, module design, enrichment, source and answer audit, correction, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (whole-curriculum structure audit, shared typesetting and selection correction, rendered-structure regression checks, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (whole-curriculum Part-scoped numbering and rendered contents hierarchy correction, rendered contents-geometry regression checking, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (starter-guide consolidation, module-flow and definition-retrieval revision, stage-boundary assessment correction, catalog and audit records, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

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